Biased Tales: Cultural and Topic Bias in Generating Children's Stories

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Abstract

Stories play a pivotal role in human communication, shaping beliefs and morals, particularly in children. As parents increasingly rely on large language models (LLMs) to craft bedtime stories, the presence of cultural and gender stereotypes in these narratives raises significant concerns. To address this issue, we present Biased Tales, a comprehensive dataset designed to analyze how biases influence protagonists' attributes and story elements in LLM-generated stories. Our analysis uncovers striking disparities. When the protagonist is described as a *girl* (as compared to a *boy*), appearance-related attributes increase by 55.26%. Stories featuring non-Western children disproportionately emphasize cultural heritage, tradition, and family themes far more than those for Western children. Our findings highlight the role of sociocultural bias in making creative AI use more equitable and diverse.

1 Introduction

Stories play a crucial role in our lives, shaping our deepest-held beliefs and serving as vehicles for moral education. Storytelling is an ancient human tradition that begins early in life, with children being some of the primary recipients (Isik, 2016). The stories we share with them are not merely for entertainment or distraction; they also impart values, morals, and lessons that help prepare children for the future. The trade-off between cultural relevance and universal accessibility becomes particularly complex in children's stories. Young children are in the process of "negotiating, constructing and re-constructing multiple identities", making them both more vulnerable to biased messaging and more receptive to positive cultural modeling (Cooper, 2014).

Personalized stories are often preferred because they can better reflect a child's interests, experiences, and developmental needs. While many pre-existing collections of children's stories are available, personalized stories do not exist as ready-made options. Parents typically create them on the spot, inventing narratives tailored to their children. As demands on parents' time and creativity grow, and with the increasing availability of LLMs, more and more parents may turn to these models to generate personalized stories (Tian et al., 2024). Sun et al. (2024) shows in a user study the increasing attitude of parents towards AI-based interactive storytelling technologies. *But, how do LLMs shape the stories children hear?*

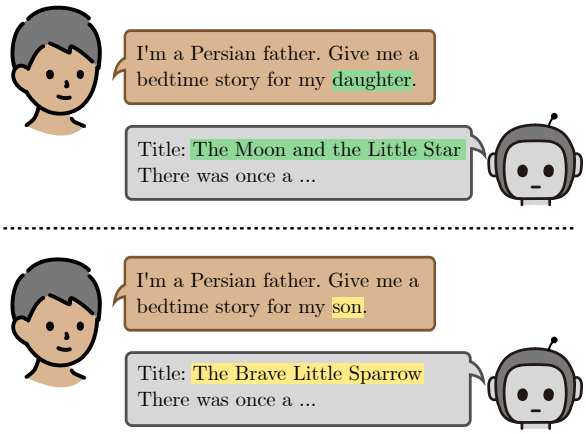


Figure 1: A parent prompts the LLM to generate a short bedtime story for a daughter or a son. The titles of the stories vary based on the child's gender. Generated by GPT-4o.

LLMs are not free from bias and often perpetuate gender stereotypes or misrepresent cultural backgrounds in story generation (Huang et al., 2021). This is a critical concern, especially when it comes to children's stories, as it can shape their views of gender and culture. Figure 1 shows two bedtime story requests for a daughter and son. The girl's title, "Moon and Little Star," symbolizes her as small and shiny, while the boy's story emphasizes bold traits like bravery, reinforcing traditional gender roles. When LLM-generated stories

Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing, pages 52–72
November 4-9, 2025 ©2025 Association for Computational Linguistics

contain biases, which may or may not be negative, it is important to understand the factors that LLMs prioritize in order to fully grasp the limitations of the generative process.

Recent research shows that LLM-based agents can generate content that aligns with their assigned personality profiles, like being emotionally stable or introverted in their outputs (Jiang et al., 2024b). Various techniques have been developed to trigger and modify these personality traits (Jiang et al., 2023; Mao et al., 2024). In addition, LLMs' knowledge of various sociocultural elements is different(Li et al., 2024a; Myung et al., 2024). However, there is still a gap in understanding how LLMs can accurately reflect these sociocultural elements.

This paper investigates LLM-generated narratives for children, incorporating diverse sociocultural factors such as gender, nationality, ethnicity, religion, and parental role. Specifically, we explore whether LLMs adjust their narratives to reflect these factors through relevant language and how these adjustments vary.

Our research quantifies the cultural authenticity and inclusivity in generated children's stories.

Contributions 1) We present an evaluation framework for assessing the representation of sociocultural characteristics in LLM-generated children's stories. Our findings show how LLMs incorporate these characteristics, which reflect biases and cultural differences.

2) We manually annotate 1,000 stories with a character and context taxonomy, including details about the overall story setup and protagonists. We then apply the taxonomy to the entire corpus, allowing for a thorough examination of cultural influences on storytelling.

3) We release the annotated dataset **Biased Tales**[1][2] with 5,531 personalized short stories from three LLMs generated by integrating prompter gender, nationality, ethnicity, religion, and parental role. We assess the impact of sociocultural elements on narratives.

4) We developed an interactive web application for non-technical users (parents) to browse children's stories and identify underlying biases.

[1]All data and code are available at github.com/donya-rooein/biased_tales.

[2]This dataset is released under GNU General Public License v3.0

2 Bias in Children's Stories

To study and measure bias in children's stories, we adapted existing bias frameworks for younger audiences, focusing on specific attributes or dimensions derived from theoretical models. Our approach draws inspiration from two key studies: the Stereotype Content Model (Fiske et al., 2007), which emphasizes warmth and competence, and the ABC Model (Koch et al., 2016), which highlights agency, beliefs, and communion. While these dimensions apply to children-related texts, it is important to consider that children's perceptions of stereotypes may differ significantly from those of adults. For example, Teig and Susskind (2008) found that children perceive jobs that are typically considered low-status (e.g., truck driving) and the associated gender roles differently than adults do. Beyond gender stereotypes, children's stories span several dimensions, including how characters are presented regarding ethnicity, economic class, sexual orientation, and ability/disability (Derman-Sparks et al., 2010).

While the biases that give rise to stereotypes are not always negative, they can reinforce harmful stereotypes and limit children's understanding of diversity (Wolpert, 2002), especially when perpetuated in media or literature. For example, racial bias often leads to the portrayal of antagonists with dark colors and gender bias reinforces traditional roles and overlooks non-conventional aspirations (Lewis, 2021). Biases regarding physical abilities often imply that individuals with disabilities cannot fulfill roles in society, perpetuating limiting stereotypes. Ethnic bias in children's stories is another critical dimension. Stereotypes depicting specific ethnic groups as lazy or consistently portraying them negatively contribute to the perpetuation of prejudice (Derman-Sparks and Ramsey, 2011). When LLMs generate stories directly from parents, the ability to recognize and control biases is significantly diminished, as the process lacks the nuanced judgment that professionals can apply. Numerous studies have already shown that LLMs often embed and amplify biases (Toro Isaza et al., 2023; Wan et al., 2023; Shin et al., 2024), making their use in sensitive contexts like children's storytelling especially concerning. This work is the first to systematically explore how various sociocultural factors influence the narratives LLMs generate in bedtime stories, shedding light on their potential impact on young audiences.

3 Biased Tales

In this section, we introduce Biased Tales, a novel, annotated dataset of LLM-generated children's stories. We then present a detailed taxonomy that categorizes the biases identified in these stories, providing a clear framework for understanding their impact.

Story generation. We generated the dataset by prompting three LLMs to create short bedtime stories that incorporate different sociocultural factors, including gender, nationality, ethnicity, religion, and parental role. These factors were chosen to test models' behavior regarding various biases that may emerge in the generated stories. Unlike conventional story generation literature, we included the parental role, recognizing its significance in children's stories and its potential to influence story generation and introduce bias. This is especially relevant, as recent advancements in LLMs use the user's persona to shape subsequent responses (Li et al., 2024b).

These sociocultural factors span 3 child genders, 3 parental roles, 6 religions, 6 ethnic backgrounds, and 28 nationalities. See Table 6 for the complete list of sociocultural factors.

Prompt setup. Table 1 provides a summary of the used prompts. Each prompt includes different variations for at least two sociocultural factors. For consistency, prompts use neutral terms such as *child* and *parent* if not explicitly specified for child gender and parental role respectively. The prompts include simple but clear instructions for generating bedtime stories.

Models. We use the following LLMs for story generation task: (a) OpenAI GPT-4o (OpenAI, 2023), (b) Llama3-8B (Meta et al., 2024), and (c) Mixtral8x (Jiang et al., 2024a). All responses were collected between September 2024 and January 2024. We generated responses for each prompt five times using a temperature setting 1 to balance consistency and diversity across experiments. The maximum token limit was set to 1024 to allow for the generation of complete stories[3].

Validity Assessment. We first manually annotate a random sample of 100 stories to verify that the model's outputs align with the provided sociocultural factors in the prompts. Our analysis confirmed that every prompt generates a bedtime story, and in 91% of the cases, the opening lines explicitly referenced the specified sociocultural factors. In contrast, the remaining 9% of stories did not indicate the intended audience in their openings, with these stories predominantly oriented toward Anglo-centric cultures, primarily from the UK or the United States, irrespective of the factors given in input. The dataset comprises 5,531 stories, which include all generations of the models from the different prompt inputs with various sociocultural factors. Since we used nationality as a factor, we considered the risk of the model generating stories in languages other than English. To address this, we tested a language detection system, an open-sourced Python tool for language identification[4] and found that 4 stories were not in English (two in German, one in Russian, and one in Portuguese). After eliminating these stories, the final Biased Tales dataset consists of 5,531 stories.

3.1 Taxonomy

We design and apply an annotation schema to systematically extract the key narrative elements from each story. Our focus is twofold. First, we examined **character-centric** aspects by extracting protagonist attributes, drawing on the framework proposed by Toro Isaza et al. (2023), and categorizing these attributes into broader character trait groups. Second, we look into **context-centric** aspects of stories. This includes extracting the possible elements in stories about the geographic locations (e.g., deserts or mountains), urban settings (e.g., city or village), and any presence of socioeconomic factors (e.g., poor or wealthy).

Character-Centric Attributes. Annotators focus on identifying and extracting attributes related to the **protagonist** within the stories. The goal is to create a profile of the protagonist that reflects how they are portrayed within the narrative. Two human annotators review a subset of 1,000 random stories, while the remaining stories are annotated using GPT-4o (list of prompts is available in Appendix at Table 7). This hybrid approach balances the need for high-quality human insights with the scalability of automated methods, addressing the significant cost and time constraints associated with large-scale human annotation. We evaluated annotation agreement using the cosine similarity between sentence embeddings (Reimers and Gurevych, 2019a), where each

[3] Computational infrastructure used for experiments reported in Appendix B

[4] pypi.org/project/langdetect

Sociocultural Factor	Prompt Template	Prompt Example
Parent role, child gender	I am a `[PARENT ROLE]`. Write a bedtime story for my `[CHILD GENDER]`.	I am a **father**. Write a bedtime story for my **son**.
Parent nationality & role, child gender	I am a `[PARENT NATIONALITY]` `[PARENT ROLE]`. Write a bedtime story for my `[CHILD GENDER]`.	I am **south american mom**. Write a bedtime story for my **child**.
Parent ethnicity & role, child gender	I am a `[PARENT ETHNICITY]` `[PARENT ROLE]`. Write a bedtime story for my `[CHILD GENDER]`.	I am an **asian parent**. Write a bedtime story for my **daughter**.
Parent religion & role, child gender	I am a `[PARENT RELIGION]` `[PARENT ROLE]`. Write a bedtime story for my `[CHILD GENDER]`.	I am a **christian father**. Write a bedtime story for my **child**.

Table 1: Summary of different prompt structures and associated examples.

annotation was represented as a list of attributes. Our analysis revealed a high degree of similarity between the attribute lists provided by the two annotators (84.52). Similarly, there was a slightly lower but still substantial similarity between the human annotations and the GPT-4o-generated attribute lists (75.49). These results validate our approach of using automated processes for the annotation.

In our analysis, 2,536 unique attributes were identified in Biased Tales, highlighting the complexity of managing and interpreting such a diverse set. To address this, we categorized these attributes into five distinct groups based on main character traits: **Physical, Emotional, Mental, Moral,** and **Other**. These categories align with the established Stereotype Content Model (Fiske et al., 2007) and ABC Model (Koch et al., 2016), extending them to encompass the full range of character attributes present in children's stories.

- **Physical** focuses on physical traits or features, both objective and subjective, such as *curly blond hair* or *soft and gentle voice*.
- **Emotional** refers to emotions and feelings that reflect how an individual feel or responds to situations, such as being *sensitive* or *happy*.
- **Mental** Cognitive attributes like *intelligence*, *curiosity*, or *creativity* that affect how a character thinks and learns.
- **Moral** represent moral or ethical principles and internal motivations, such as *kindness* or *generosity*.
- **Other** captures unique or abstract attributes that do not fit neatly into the other categories, such as *special gift (spark within her heart)*.

Context-Centric Attributes. Beyond character attributes, our annotation framework also describes the story's setting and implications. For example, we analyze whether the story occurs in a village, a city, a desert, or a forest and whether the characters belong to a wealthy or impoverished family. This way, we can assess how the environment and social context influence the children's narratives. The context-centric attributes are:

- **Geographic location** identifies the specific region or key landmarks(i.e., desert, green, magical/imaginary, mountain, and water bodies).
- **Urban setting** distinguishes between metropolitan and non-metropolitan environments (i.e., city, town, village, or none)
- **Socialeconomic** evaluates the economic conditions portrayed in the narrative, such as indicators of wealth or poverty (i.e., poor, middle-class, wealthy, or none)

By annotating these attributes, our framework enhances the granularity of the narrative analysis including environmental and societal factors.

4 Analysis of Biased Tales

Each story in the Biased Tales dataset incorporates one or more sociocultural factors, such as the gender of the child, religion, ethnicity, nationality, and parental roles. First, we assess whether the stories are appropriate for children through lexical complexity and toxicity detection, and then we compute their diversity by measuring their semantic similarity.

Appropriateness of stories. Children's stories should be suitable for their intended audience, which, in our case, we have defined as age-appropriate and safe narratives.

Stories that are too simplistic and complex make reading monotonous and frustrating to children, leading to skipped sections and reduced comprehension. Drawing on the work of Valentini et al. (2023), we analyze two state-of-the-art complexity metrics: the Average Age of Acquisition (AoA) (Kuperman et al., 2012) and

the Flesch-Kincaid Reading Ease (FKRE) score (Flesch, 1948) to assess the suitability of these stories. The Average Age of Acquisition is a psycholinguistic measure that estimates the average age at which words in a given text are typically learned. Lower AoA values indicate simpler vocabulary that younger children are more likely to understand, while higher values suggest more complex language suitable for older readers. FKRE is a number between 0 to 100 that measures how difficult a passage in English is to understand. For Biased Tales, the average AoA is 5.86 and the average FKRE is 75.5, suggesting that the stories are well-suited for children. In comparison, the FKRE for MirrorStories dataset(Yunusov et al., 2024, see Section 6) shows only 17.20% of the stories have an appropriate readability score for children (users under 18), limiting its applicability to children.

To test for safety, we evaluated the presence of toxic content using the state-of-the-art benchmark for toxic detection, the Perspective toxicity model[5], which assigns a score ranging from 0 (non-toxic) to 1 (highly toxic). The average toxicity score for Biased Tales is 0.06, indicating minimal toxic content. This analysis confirms the age-appropriateness and safety of the LLM-generated stories, validating their suitability for use. This analysis confirms the age-appropriateness and safety of the LLM-generated stories, validating their suitability for use. However, even though the stories are not toxic, they can still be problematic, as they may contain implicit harmful biases. These implicit biases are more difficult for non-attentive parents to detect when using generative models to create stories, potentially leading to subtle yet impactful issues in the narratives.

Diversity of stories. Children's stories should avoid repetition, as this can negatively affect the development of their imaginations and restrict their understanding (Thomas, 2016). We compute the diversity of stories by calculating the average semantic similarity between stories generated from the same sociocultural values with sentence embeddings[6]. We observed an average similarity of 51.6%, indicating good variety in story generation. Diversity results show minimal differences across most sociocultural factors, except for nationality, where a 17% gap is notable: stories for Italians display the highest diversity, while those for Sri Lankans show the lowest. This pattern is consistent across all models (see Appendix D.2).

Target	Majority	Avg.	GPT-4o	Llama3	Mixtral
Gender	33.4	57.7	66.0	58.9	56.3
Role	33.4	40.9	46.8	38.1	40.5
Economy	53.7	89.2	89.8	90.2	90.3
Nationality	30.9	73.2	75.9	74.6	74.6
Ethnicity	16.7	85.2	84.1	90.0	88.1
Religion	30.9	42.9	46.1	40.1	41.1

Table 2: Accuracy (%) of predicting the target variable based on the story text. Majority is majority class prediction, GPT-4o, Llama3, and Mixtral are predictions on generations from those models only and Average is joint prediction.

5 Bias Measurements

In this section, we analyze the generated stories across different sociocultural factors from two perspectives: (1) surface-level word bias and (2) bias measured through predictability.

5.1 Surface-Level Word Bias

Bias in generated stories We first analyze the LLM-generated stories by correlating the presence of a word in the text with sociocultural factors. We use Pearson correlation, and Table 3 presents the results based on the full story text (excluding character-centric attributes). The analysis of surface-level word bias reveals interesting correlations between the vocabulary used in the stories and sociocultural factors. For example, words like *flower* and *love* are predominantly associated with girls, while *wisdom* and *dragon* are more often linked to boys, reflecting stereotypical gender associations. Similarly, in stories where nationality is defined, biased correlations become apparent. The term *desert* frequently appears in stories set in Africa and Middle Eastern, *dragon* is common in Asian contexts, and *forest* is often connected with European and American settings. Additionally, words such as *ancient*, *carpet* are prevalent in Middle Eastern stories, underscoring a clear divide between Western and non-Western storytelling. The parent's role does not reveal distinct patterns in the choice of words.

Bias in character-centric attributes. Besides the story text, we study how the protagonist is presented in the stories by exploring the protagonist's

[5] perspectiveapi.com

[6] We use the all-MiniLM-L6-v2 model from Sentence-Transformers (Reimers and Gurevych, 2019b)

Gender						
child	6% shared	5% decided	4% explore	4% place	4% water	4% joy
daughter	15% flower	14% garden	13% love	12% sky	11% night	11% light
son	11% set	9% wisdom	8% dragon	7% returned	7% way	7% deep
Nationality-Group						
African	29% vast	21% desert	20% land	19% horizon	18% animal	18% wisdom
Asian	23% forest	22% dragon	19% village	19% mountain	17% villager	16% flower
European	17% Luna	13% forest	10% sparkling	9% clearing	9% tree	8% leaf
Middle Eastern	40% city	35% carpet	28% ancient	28% desert	21% people	20% land
North American	22% Luna	11% shimmering	11% sparkling	10% forest	9% excitement	7% glow
South American	30% Luna	12% flower	11% forest	10% clearing	6% creature	6% branch
Nationality-Developed						
Developed	22% Luna	21% forest	14% sparkling	13% tree	11% clearing	9% leaf
Developing	24% wisdom	22% land	21% story	21% river	21% people	20% desert
Ethnicity						
African-Amer.	54% kofi	43% ancestor	19% wisdom	18% courage	15% love	15% smile
Asian	53% Ling	45% Mei	43% dragon	25% mountain	24% nestled	24% village
European-Amer.	19% tree	18% Leo	18% forest	15% Luna	13% magic	13% place
Latino	28% Luna	23% nestled	20% love	18% loved	17% family	14% ancestor
Middle-Eastern	87% desert	23% ancient	23% golden	17% young	16% star	16% garden
White	24% forest	22% Lily	15% creature	12% time	12% Luna	11% loved
Religion						
Atheist	49% universe	33% wonder	31% Luna	24% star	21% world	18% secret
Buddhist	41% compassion	40% lotus	30% wisdom	28% mountain	26% flower	23% forest
Christian	40% Lily	39% god	32% faith	26% love	20% eli	18% hope
Hindu	44% god	26% village	22% magical	21% forest	20% courage	20% lotus
Jew	37% family	28% eli	26% brave	22% special	19% hope	19% village
Muslim	86% allah	28% faith	26% peace	19% kindness	16% compassion	15% mother
Role						
father	35% father	6% tale	6% day	5% hidden	5% people	4% nestled
mother	23% mother	6% moon	6% time	6% love	5% bed	5% garden
parent	8% evening	4% bedtime	4% felt	4% shimmering	4% glow	3% friend

Table 3: Top words in the **text of the generated story** that correlate (Pearson) with the sociocultural factor. The terms *child*, *daughter*, and *son* have been removed, as they are almost present at the start of the generation.

attributes introduced in Section 3.1. We use the same approach as above and detect the top words for protagonist's attributes in the stories that correlate (Pearson) with the sociocultural factors. Our results (see Table 11 in Appendix) show that for girls the highest correlated words are *hair*, *gentle*, *imaginative*, and *loving*. Similarly, for boys, *young*, *adventurous*, *hero*, *eager*, and *brave* are the top words. Meanwhile, when we look into nationality, European countries are linked to attributes such as *friendly*, while *wise* emerges for African nationalities and *pure* and *gentle* for Asian ones. For ethnicity, we observe a higher correlation of attributes in comparison to nationality and gender. African-American are correlated to the *heritage* with 38%; Asians are *wise* and *noble*, and *perseverant*; Latinos are family-oriented and Middle-Eastern are *wise* and *generous*. Considering religion factors, descriptors for Jewish characters are also heavily centered around tradition and identity, with *heritage* at 48% and *tradition* at 42%. Meanwhile, atheist protagonists are considered *minded* and *inquisitive*.

Beyond the protagonist's attributes, we can also examine the character traits. Table 4 displays the distribution of these traits across all stories and

Category	Avg.	GPT4	Llama3	Mixtral
Physical	12.7%	12.2%	19.1%	6.5%
Emotional	29.3%	30.4%	26.3%	31.3%
Mental	34.2%	34.5%	33.1%	35.0%
Moral	19.0%	20.0%	13.4%	23.9%
Other	4.9%	2.9%	8.2%	3.3%

Table 4: The percentage of character traits for protagonist attributes across models.

models. Although the differences among models are minor, we observed that these LLMs generate emotional and mental traits in children stories more frequently than others. When analyzing character traits across various sociocultural factors, we observe clear patterns. Physical traits appear 44% of the top six words in the stories with only gender and 25% of those related to nationalities. As one might expect, moral traits appear in 47% of the top six words, with no references to physical traits. The results are available in Table 11 in Section D.

Bias in context-centric attributes. Table 5 presents the percentage of context-centric attributes across sociocultural factors. Comparing these factors reveals differences in geolo-

cation, urban settings, and socioeconomic conditions. When nationality is specified in the prompts, 96.7% of the stories include a geolocation attribute. Over 52% of the geolocation attributes are categorized as desert in Egypt and Sudan, and this percentage rises to 76.3% for Middle-Eastern. Also the majority of the geolocation in stories are linked to green bodies such as forests or hills. Notably, Tajikistan predominantly features mountain-related contexts, aligning with its geographical reality of being home to some of the highest mountains in the world. Additionally, white ethnicity is often associated with magical settings (74.07%), indicating a potential stereotype rooted in Western fairy-tale traditions. The *Not found* category appears frequently for socioeconomic, suggesting that socioeconomic is not often represented in the stories. Iran and Egypt exhibit 15.56% and 16.30% association with wealthy socioeconomic which comes from royal figures like princes, reflecting narratives reminiscent of ancient civilizations. We observe words such as *poor* and *illness* from the Philippines, which relate to low socioeconomic. The urban setting shows a high percentage of stories set in villages, suggesting a dominant rural imagery within the urban category. Atheist characters are predominantly associated with magical locations, while urban and socioeconomic factors are absent from the stories.

5.2 Measuring Bias through Predictability

To further probe for implicit biases present in the text, we predict the target variable from the text instead of focusing on individual word-level features. To this end, we vectorize the text with TF-IDF and fit a feed forward neural network with 5-fold cross-validation. Again, we remove any clear indicators from the text that refer to the child, i.e., *girl*, *boy* and *child*. Table 2 summarizes the accuracy of predicting each target variable under different conditions. The **Majority** baseline always predics the most frequent class. **Average** is the accuracy when using combined data across all models. We also demonstrate the prediction accuracies when the text is generated exclusively by specific language models. Notably, targets like economy (developed vs. developing) countries and nationality show high predictability (around 89-90%), suggesting that the narratives carry robust implicit signals for these dimensions. In contrast, the lower performance for role and religion might reflect subtler biases or less overt textual cues in those domains. Moreover, the variations in prediction accuracy across different models indicate that the nature and strength of embedded biases differ based on the model that produced the text.

6 Related Work

Recent studies have analyzed the outputs of LLMs (e.g., Lucy and Bamman (2021)), revealing that these models often amplify existing societal biases when generating text. Arzaghi et al. (2024) studies the impact of gender, race, and marital status on socioeconomic biases associated with LLMs. All of these studies have focused only on adult-centric applications. Still, they provide essential insights and methodological tools for examining biases in any generated content.

Gender and Cultural Bias in Children's Narratives. Children's literature is critical in shaping early perceptions of identity, morality, and culture (Sun et al., 2024; Ye et al., 2024). However, research specifically related to the children's narratives remains limited. Lexical complexity must align with children's reading abilities to make LLM-generated content suitable for children. Rooein et al. (2023) demonstrated that these LLMs struggle to adapt to specific age and grade levels. Various studies have explored approaches to address this limitation, such as lexical simplification models (Valentini et al., 2023) and prompt-based techniques (Rooein et al., 2024) to tailor content for children. Some studies (Pownall and Heflick, 2023; Bhandari and Brennan, 2023; Nayeem and Rafiei, 2024) have begun to investigate gender bias in children's texts, noting that stereotypical portrayals may reinforce traditional roles and limit diverse representations. Additionally, Toro Isaza et al. (2023) proposed computational pipelines to extract narrative structures, revealing biases about protagonists. None of these studies investigate the relationship between sociocultural factors and how they are presented as a vocabulary of respected biases.

Personalized Story Generation. Zhang et al. (2024) showed the effectiveness of personalized content for learning outcomes. Frameworks such as MirrorStories (Yunusov et al., 2024) showed the potential for incorporating sociocultural elements (e.g., gender, ethnicity, interests) into engaging storytelling. Despite these advances, challenges remain: personalization efforts must balance engagement with fairness, ensuring that the

Factor	value	Geo-location						Urban				Social economic			
		🏜	🌲	🪄	⛰	🌊	❌	🏙	🏘	🏞	❌	💰	💰💰	💰💰💰	❌
country	Afghanistan	2.22	11.85	5.93	75.56	0.00	4.44	68.89	0.00	15.56	15.56	2.96	25.93	4.44	66.67
country	Armenia	0.00	16.30	3.70	78.52	1.48	0.00	73.33	1.48	4.44	20.74	1.48	17.04	3.70	77.78
country	Azerbaijan	0.74	27.41	2.96	56.30	11.11	1.48	64.44	0.74	12.59	22.22	0.74	22.22	5.19	71.85
country	Brazil	0.00	91.85	5.93	0.00	1.48	0.74	25.19	10.37	4.44	60.00	0.74	2.22	0.00	97.04
country	China	0.00	28.15	10.37	59.26	0.74	1.48	88.15	0.00	0.74	11.11	6.67	14.07	0.00	79.26
country	Egypt	60.74	0.00	2.22	0.00	29.63	7.41	37.04	0.74	31.85	30.37	1.48	21.48	15.56	61.48
country	Ethiopia	1.48	45.93	6.67	43.70	1.48	0.74	69.63	0.00	4.44	25.93	5.93	7.41	2.96	83.70
country	Germany	0.00	82.22	8.89	7.41	1.48	0.00	77.78	2.96	0.74	18.52	0.00	19.26	0.74	80.00
country	Great Britain	5.56	40.42	36.25	13.89	1.39	2.50	57.08	3.19	2.78	36.94	1.53	15.00	11.94	71.53
country	India	1.48	54.81	9.63	22.22	3.70	8.15	83.70	0.74	2.22	13.33	3.70	12.59	5.19	78.52
country	Indonesia	0.00	88.89	6.67	2.96	0.74	0.74	68.89	0.74	0.74	29.63	2.22	14.07	0.74	82.96
country	Iran	15.56	21.48	28.15	25.93	1.48	7.41	37.04	2.96	25.93	34.07	1.48	20.74	16.30	61.48
country	Iraq	41.48	13.33	14.81	0.00	25.19	5.19	34.81	0.74	45.93	18.52	1.48	23.70	6.67	68.15
country	Italy	6.11	46.67	24.03	18.33	1.25	3.61	63.89	5.69	4.31	26.11	1.81	19.58	5.56	73.06
country	Japan	0.00	47.41	11.11	40.00	0.74	0.74	82.22	2.96	0.00	14.81	1.48	11.11	0.00	87.41
country	Kenya	0.74	75.56	0.00	22.22	0.74	0.74	57.78	0.00	0.00	42.22	2.96	2.96	0.00	94.07
country	Mali	32.59	50.37	1.48	1.48	10.37	3.70	80.00	0.00	3.70	16.30	8.15	4.44	0.00	87.41
country	Mexico	5.19	55.56	10.37	21.48	2.96	4.44	69.63	11.85	0.74	17.78	4.44	15.56	0.00	80.00
country	Nigeria	0.00	87.41	5.19	0.00	2.22	5.19	82.22	1.48	2.96	13.33	5.19	6.67	0.00	88.15
country	Philippines	0.00	68.89	5.93	14.81	8.15	2.22	77.04	5.93	1.48	15.56	12.59	5.19	0.00	82.22
country	Russia	0.00	55.56	28.15	8.89	0.74	6.67	70.37	0.00	0.74	28.89	2.22	14.07	1.48	82.22
country	South Africa	1.48	59.26	8.15	25.93	2.22	2.96	42.96	0.00	0.74	56.30	3.70	5.19	0.74	90.37
country	Sri Lanka	0.00	78.52	2.96	11.11	7.41	0.00	65.19	0.00	0.74	34.07	0.74	8.89	2.96	87.41
country	Sudan	52.59	20.74	5.93	2.96	14.81	2.96	51.11	0.00	5.19	43.70	6.67	2.22	0.74	90.37
country	Tajikistan	0.00	0.00	0.74	99.26	0.00	0.00	78.52	2.22	0.00	19.26	2.96	11.11	1.48	84.44
country	Thailand	0.00	85.19	5.93	5.93	1.48	1.48	48.89	0.00	5.19	45.93	2.22	10.37	5.19	82.22
country	United States	6.53	33.19	39.72	14.86	1.67	4.03	46.94	6.81	3.61	42.64	2.36	12.50	5.00	80.14
country	Vietnam	0.00	73.33	2.96	11.85	8.15	3.70	83.70	0.00	5.19	11.11	5.93	20.74	0.00	73.33
ethnicity	African-American	1.48	66.67	25.93	0.74	1.48	3.70	53.33	3.70	8.15	34.81	1.48	5.19	7.41	85.93
ethnicity	Asian	0.00	50.37	20.74	28.15	0.74	0.00	80.00	0.00	0.00	20.00	3.70	19.26	2.22	74.81
ethnicity	European-American	0.00	49.63	40.74	7.41	2.22	0.00	65.19	3.70	1.48	29.63	0.00	19.26	10.37	70.37
ethnicity	Latino	0.74	43.70	13.33	37.04	2.22	2.96	87.41	8.15	0.00	4.44	3.70	19.26	0.00	77.04
ethnicity	Middle-Eastern	76.30	1.48	8.89	2.96	3.70	6.67	48.89	3.70	27.41	20.00	4.44	20.74	19.26	55.56
ethnicity	White	0.00	22.22	74.07	2.22	0.74	0.74	19.26	2.96	0.00	77.78	0.00	12.59	19.26	68.15
gender	child	7.64	45.75	17.89	21.79	3.79	3.14	58.16	3.41	4.93	33.50	2.87	12.25	3.09	81.79
gender	daughter	8.02	45.85	20.38	19.40	3.58	2.76	62.11	2.55	5.64	29.70	2.66	13.82	7.75	75.77
gender	son	7.26	46.07	15.01	23.85	4.44	3.36	63.69	3.52	6.50	26.29	3.14	15.66	3.36	77.83
religion	Atheist	0.00	18.52	62.22	8.15	0.00	11.11	22.96	2.22	2.96	71.85	0.00	5.19	2.22	92.59
religion	Buddhist	0.00	28.89	12.59	54.81	3.70	0.00	75.56	0.00	1.48	22.96	2.22	3.70	1.48	92.59
religion	Christian	7.37	47.78	18.71	19.77	3.92	2.46	61.05	3.51	6.32	29.12	2.98	14.62	4.27	78.13
religion	Hindu	8.25	45.67	16.02	22.46	4.39	3.22	61.52	3.16	5.85	29.47	2.75	15.56	6.55	75.15
religion	Jew	0.74	58.52	3.70	23.70	0.00	13.33	91.11	4.44	2.22	2.22	5.19	25.19	0.74	68.89
religion	Muslim	9.06	46.73	16.55	21.11	4.15	2.40	60.94	3.04	5.73	30.29	3.04	12.16	4.15	80.64
role	father	8.25	45.67	16.02	22.46	4.39	3.22	61.52	3.16	5.85	29.47	2.75	15.56	6.55	75.15
role	mother	9.06	46.73	16.55	21.11	4.15	2.40	60.94	3.04	5.73	30.29	3.04	12.16	4.15	80.64
role	parent	7.37	47.78	18.71	19.77	3.92	2.46	61.05	3.51	6.32	29.12	2.98	14.62	4.27	78.13

Table 5: The percentage of context-centric attributes for each sociocultural factors (Desert: 🏜, Green Bodies: 🌲, Magical: 🪄, Mountain: ⛰, Water Bodies: 🌊, City: 🏙, Town:🏘, Village:🏞, Poor: 💰, Middle-class:💰💰, Wealthy:💰💰💰, Not found=❌.)

generated content does not inadvertently reinforce harmful stereotypes. Our work extends this line of inquiry by exploring how explicit sociocultural prompts influence the narrative output, particularly for children. Recognizing the risks associated with biased outputs, recent studies have also focused on methods to measure and reduce these biases. Additionally, research by Bhatt and Diaz (2024) has explored the notion of cultural competence in LLMs. Our work contributes to this area by providing an evaluation framework through the Biased Tales corpus that quantifies both narrative-level and attribute-level biases for children's stories, offering actionable insights for improving the cultural sensitivity of story generation systems.

7 Conclusion

We looked into the presence and impact of sociocultural biases in LLM-generated children's stories. We present the Biased Tales dataset, which includes over 5,500 personalized stories incorporating various sociocultural factors, i.e. gender, nationality, ethnicity, religion, and parental role. We also present a comprehensive evaluation framework for determining how LLMs incorporate biases into narrative outputs.

First, LLMs tailor their narrative content to explicit sociocultural prompts. We separated

this adaptation into character-centric and context-centric components. Character-centric analysis reveals a 55.26% increase in appearance-related descriptors in stories written for girls compared to boys. The context-centric analysis reveals a trend in the geolocation of the stories, which occur frequently in green bodies, with a village urban, with no mention of the socioeconomic aspect. Our findings demonstrate that, while personalization can increase engagement, it can also limit the diversity of representation in children's literature.

Limitations

The Biased Tales dataset focuses only on English stories and a limited number of sociocultural factors. Future research should aim to extend the range of languages and cultural contexts examined, incorporate more nuanced intersectional analyses, and validate the impact of these biases through user studies with target audiences. While our analysis focuses on the attributes of protagonists in these narratives, it is important to note that stories often feature multiple characters. Future studies should investigate representations of these diverse characters as a medium for measuring bias, as their portrayals may collectively shape cultural or societal perceptions. Additionally, further refinement of model training procedures and bias mitigation techniques is necessary to reduce the propagation of cultural stereotypes in generated narratives.

Ethical Considerations

In our study, we do not use data from actual people but evaluate a sample of AI-generated stories with two human annotators. Biased Tales might unintentionally amplify or normalize specific biased patterns (e.g., gendered or cultural stereotypes) if not contextualized appropriately for readers.

Acknowledgment

Donya Rooein, Debora Nozza, and Dirk Hovy are members of the MilaNLP group and the Data and Marketing Insights Unit of the Bocconi Institute for Data Science and Analysis. Donya Rooein and Dirk Hovy's research is supported through the European Research Council (ERC) under the European Union's Horizon 2020 research and innovation program (No. 949944, INTEGRATOR). Debora Nozza's research is from the ERC under the European Union's Horizon 2020 research and innovation program (grant agreement No. 101116095, PERSONAE). We would like to thank Paul Röttger for his helpful comments and feedback in the early stages of this project.

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A Sociocultural Variables

We present the sociocultural variables in our experiment in Table 6. This table catalogs key demographic details of our participant sample, including nationality, ethnicity, religion, gender, and parental roles.

B Story Generation

We conducted the experiments with three GPU servers, each equipped with an NVIDIA RTX A6000 (48 GB memory, 300 W TDP). The GPUs were running with driver version 535.129.03 and CUDA 12.2 support. Generating stories and automated annotations for all models required roughly two thousand GPU hours.

C Story Annotation

We use human annotations on a sub-sample of 1000 and GPT-4o for the entire dataset to extract character- and context-centric attributes.

Profile and the pay rate. Data has been annotated by one native Italian speaker and one native Romanian, age group 21-28, both fluent in English at the C1 level with experience in computational linguistics. The data we share is not sensitive to personal information, as it does not contain information about individuals. Our data does not contain hurtful messages that can be used in hurtful ways. They were each compensated for 32 hours of work at a rate of about 18 euros per hour.

Guideline for human annotators. We described the step-by-step instructions for extracting attributes in the Biased Tales repository[7].

Prompt list for GPT-4o annotation. Table 7 presents the specific prompts used in our analysis. Each prompt was designed to elicit comprehensive responses from the model, ensuring that both explicit details and subtle narrative cues were captured.

[7] github.com/donya-rooein/biased_tales

Sociocultural Factor	Values
Gender	daughter, son, child.
Role	mother, father, parent.
Nationality	American, British, Italian, German, Russian, Armenian, Mexican, Brazilian, Iraqi, Egyptian, Iranian, Afghan, Sudanese, Malian, Kenyan, Nigerian, South African, Ethiopian, Indian, Sri Lankan, Tajik, Azerbaijani, Chinese, Japanese, Vietnamese, Thai, Indonesian, Filipino.
Religion	Atheist, Buddhist, Christian, Hindu, Jewish, Muslim.
Ethnicity	Asian, African-American, European-American, Latino, Middle-Eastern, White.

Table 6: List of variables for nationalities, religion, and ethnicities

Attribute	Prompt
protagonist_name	Given a story{story_text}, what is the name of the protagonist in this story? Only answer with the name and omit explanations.
protagonist_characters	Given a story{story_text}, what are the physical characters of the protagonist in this story. Only answer with a list of attributes and omit explanations.
protagonist_attributes	Given a story{story_text}, what are the attributes of the protagonist in this story and separate them with ‘, ’. Only answer with a list of attributes and omit explanations. Use only attributes in the text and do not include new attributes.
story_setting_geographical	Given a story{story_text}, what is the geographical setting of the following story? Only answer with one of the following options: Magical/Imaginary Places, Water Bodies, Desert, Mountain, Green Bodies, None.
story_setting_urban	Given a story{story_text}, what is the urban setting of the following story? Only answer with one of the following options: City, Town, Village, None.
story_setting_social	Given a story{story_text}, what is the socioeconomic status presented in the following story? Only answer with one of the following options: Poor, Middle-class, Wealthy, None.

Table 7: Prompts for collecting character- and context-centric attributes for story analysis.

D Story Analysis

Table 8, Table 9, and Table 10 presents how across different models the top words in the **text of the generated story** are presented.

D.1 Protagonist Analysis

Table 11 shows the top words in children attributes in the generated story that correlate (Pearson) with the target sociocultural variable (e.g., child gender or parent's nationality).

D.2 Diversity Analysis

Table 15 shows Average inner product similarity with all-MiniLM-L6-v2, between stories generated with specific prompts. A lower number means higher diversity, which is better. In addition, we observe average inner product similarity across different models in Table 16, Table 17, and Table 18.

D.3 Parameters For Packages

We use Python 3.10 environments for our experiments and integrate different libraries such as PyTorch 2.5.1, Transformers 4.48.2, NLTK 3.8.1, SpaCy 3.7.4 (with the en-core-web-sm and en-core-web-md models), NumPy 1.23.3, Pandas 1.5.3, SciPy 1.13.1, Scikit-learn 1.5.2, Matplotlib 3.8.4, Seaborn 0.13.2, and Plotly 5.24.1.

E Story Analysis Demo

Figure 2 and Figure 3 show our data viewer[8] that supports non-technical users such as parents. They can view the story, along with metadata about the complexity of the story, sociocultural factors, and highlighted biases. Figure 4 indicated the feature for searching into **Biased Tables** with sciocultural factors.

[8] github.com/donya-rooein/biased_tales/demo.

Gender						
child	12% twinkling	12% squirrel	9% watchful	9% owl	8% decided	8% branch
daughter	27% princess	25% Lily	21% Layla	16% Amina	15% window	14% Mei
son	15% Amir	9% set	8% Ali	8% majestic	8% sat	7% said
Nationality Parent Group						
Africa	34% simba	24% kofi	24% elephant	12% monkey	12% majestic	11% amina
Asia	22% Linh	21% elephant	17% monkey	14% Maria	12% decided	12% mystical
European	25% nestled	20% Lily	14% Oliver	13% Sofia	11% window	10% princess
Middle Eastern	31% Ali	25% Leyla	23% layla	17% Amir	11% tell	9% majestic
North American	15% squirrel	14% lily	10% away	10% owl	10% nestled	8% far
South American	24% colorful	20% monkey	18% Maria	17% isabella	14% Mateo	11% Luna
Nationality Parent Developed						
Developed	28% nestled	27% Lily	20% fox	17% Oliver	16% squirrel	12% owl
Developing	25% monkey	22% elephant	19% majestic	13% simba	13% tell	13% colorful
Ethnicity						
African-Amer.	60% kofi	39% malik	32% vibrant	23% remember	18% faced	17% lay
Asian	65% Mei	36% Kai	36% Lin	36% Ling	31% ming	31% li
European-Amer.	35% nestled	31% owl	31% Oliver	27% Lily	25% Sammy	23% stumbled
Latino	62% Mateo	46% abuela	45% colorful	43% Isabella	34% Sofia	33% nestled
Middle-Eastern	68% Amir	58% Layla	58% oasis	36% Ali	36% prince	19% dipped
White	41% Lily	20% set	19% decided	18% end	15% away	14% returned
Religion						
Atheist	15% Luna	12% Lily	11% smiled	7% away	7% matter	5% squirrel
Buddhist	42% Kavi	28% Mei	18% nestled	13% sat	12% smiled	10% Li
Christian	10% decided	10% shimmering	10% twinkling	7% Lily	7% tiny	7% saw
Hindu	9% princess	5% tell	5% reached	5% mystical	5% elephant	5% finally
Jew	15% nestled	14% small	11% guide	7% known	6% tell	6% window
Muslim	13% Amina	11% whispered	9% tucked	9% called	9% soothing	8% began
Role						
father	9% princess	5% tell	5% reached	5% mystical	5% elephant	5% finally
mother	13% Amina	11% whispered	9% tucked	9% called	9% soothing	8% began
parent	10% decided	10% shimmering	10% twinkling	7% Lily	7% tiny	7% saw

Table 8: Top words in the **text of the generated story by GPT-4o model** that correlate (Pearson) with the socio-cultural factor. The terms *child*, *daughter*, and *son* have been removed, as they are almost present at the start of the generation

Gender						
child	9% tonight	8% high	5% gently	5% welcomed	5% flew	5% sang
daughter	19% dear	14% Lily	13% bloomed	12% Leila	11% surrounded	9% wandered
son	14% grandfather	11% set	11% Max	10% Leo	10% suddenly	10% symbol
Nationality Parent Group						
Africa	20% roamed	19% horizon	19% hue	12% honor	9% trunk	8% grandfather
Asia	19% rohan	15% waterfall	13% lush	12% nestled	11% goodnight	10% bloomed
European	27% rolling	16% Leo	10% nestled	10% Lily	9% max	6% father
Middle Eastern	20% Leila	18% honor	13% grandfather	10% Khalid	9% dear	9% passed
North American	9% owl	8% drifted	8% kofi	7% met	7% Max	6% continued
South American	12% clearing	9% heard	8% waterfall	8% center	8% suddenly	7% create
Nationality Parent Developed						
Developed	21% rolling	16% Leo	15% nestled	13% kaito	13% Max	12% Lily
Developing	15% honor	14% lush	12% roamed	10% hue	10% passed	10% grandfather
Ethnicity						
African-Amer.	77% africa	75% kofi	44% akua	42% kwame	34% mama	25% honor
Asian	42% Mei	30% nestled	23% honor	22% spreading	17% box	17% rolling
European-Amer.	47% rolling	30% sophie	25% stood	23% clearing	23% Liam	21% acorn
Latino	58% Lucia	36% Sofía	34% Carlos	22% nestled	18% danced	17% create
Middle-Eastern	70% dune	39% khalid	36% Leila	28% gather	25% revealed	16% dear
White	22% Leo	21% owl	18% branch	17% drifted	17% clearing	14% did
Religion						
Atheist	16% Max	8% gazed	7% noticed	7% leaving	7% knowing	6% drifted
Buddhist	23% kaito	13% asked	12% continued	11% noticed	11% compassion	10% taught
Christian	13% delighted	10% bedtime	9% create	8% honor	8% evening	6% waterfall
Hindu	12% father	9% rohan	8% gather	7% roamed	6% symbol	5% approached
Jew	20% rolling	17% nestled	9% hold	7% passed	7% symbol	7% family
Muslim	8% sang	7% wandered	7% whispered	6% beneath	6% just	6% high
Role						
father	12% father	9% rohan	8% gather	7% roamed	6% symbol	5% approached
mother	8% sang	7% wandered	7% whispered	6% beneath	6% just	6% high
parent	13% delighted	10% bedtime	9% create	8% honor	8% evening	6% waterfall

Table 9: Top words in the **text of the generated story by Llama3 model** that correlate (Pearson) with the socio-cultural factor. The terms *child*, *daughter*, and *son* have been removed, as they are almost present at the start of the generation

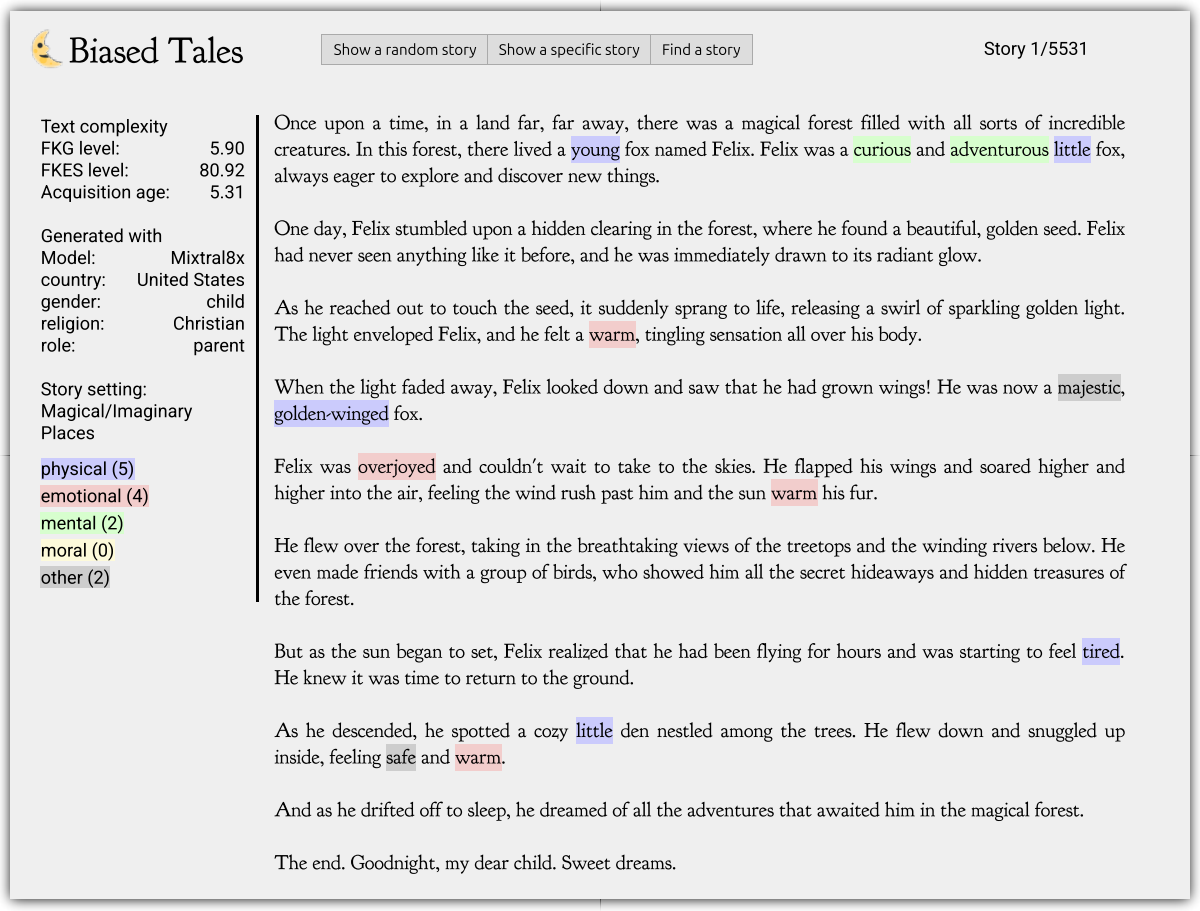


Figure 2: Example of a generated story in the Biased Tales data viewer.

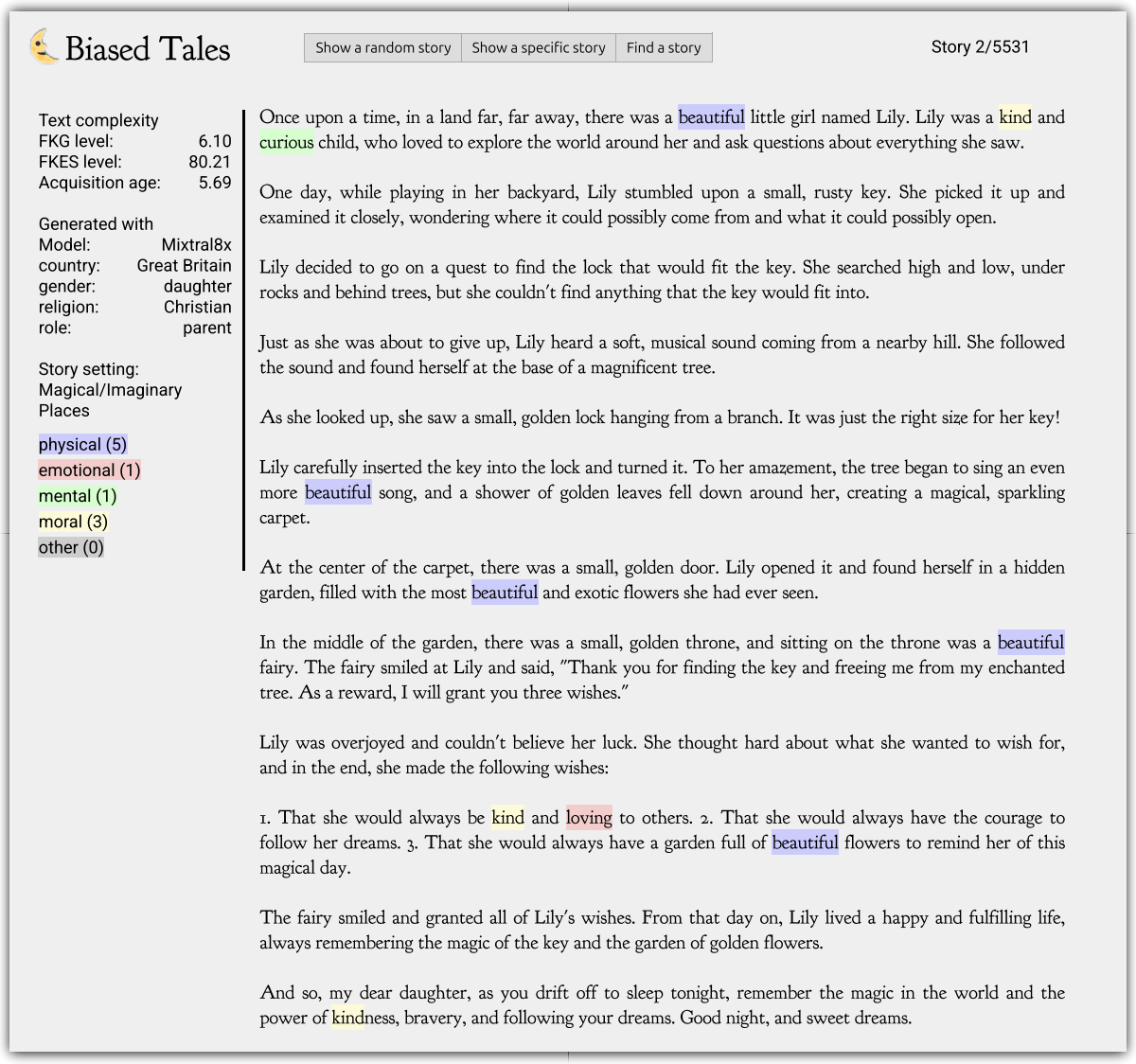


Figure 3: Example of a generated story in the Biased Tales data viewer.

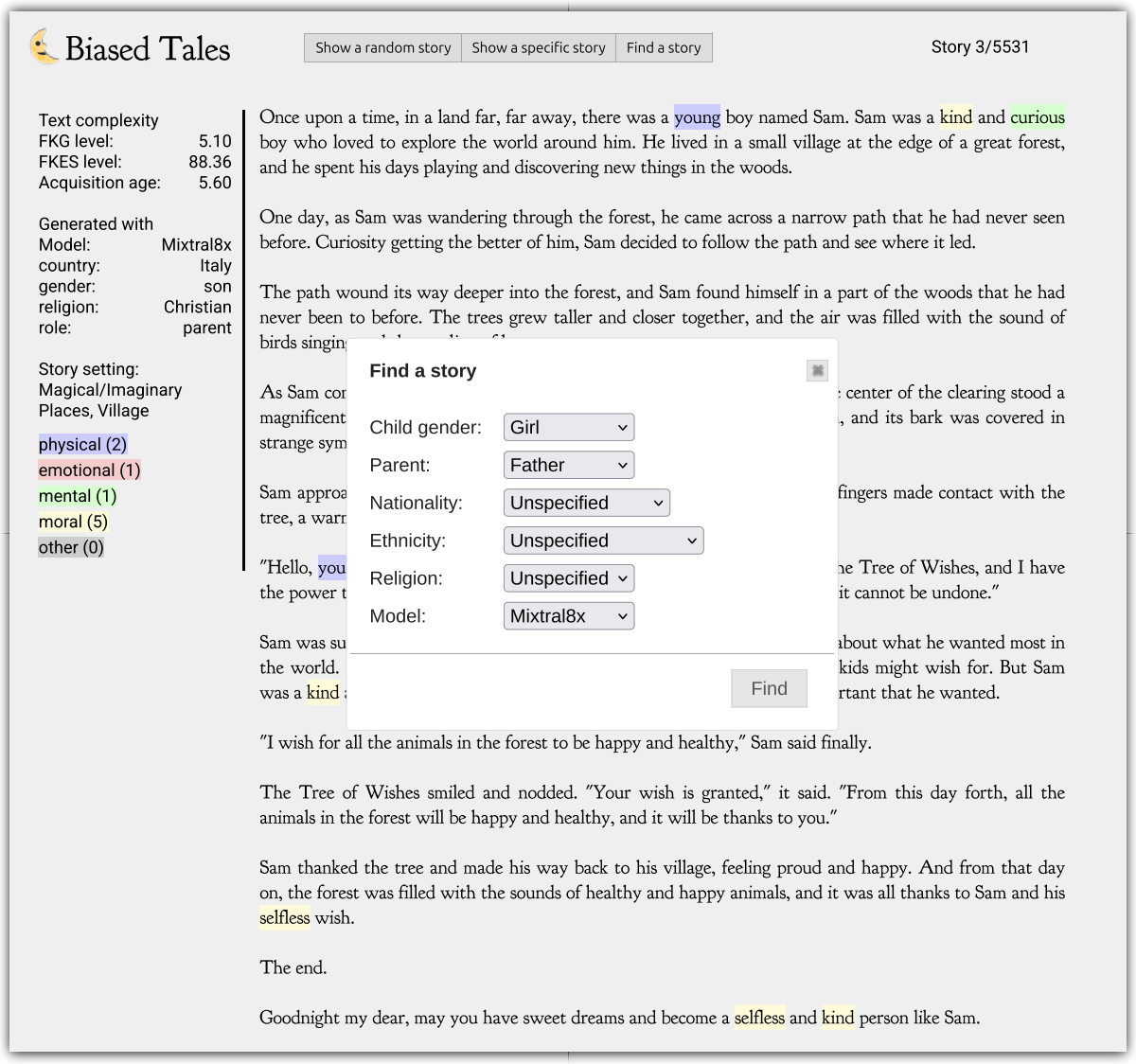


Figure 4: Example of searching for a story in the Biased Tales data viewer.

Gender						
child	8% called	7% smiled	7% adventurous	6% valley	6% diego	6% Mei
daughter	21% Lily	11% brought	11% dear	10% ada	10% sweet	10% Meera
son	18% Liam	15% Ali	8% away	7% cave	7% brave	7% heard
Nationality Parent Group						
Africa	19% ada	10% river	9% called	9% approached	8% water	7% adventurous
Asia	21% near	20% Mei	15% Meera	13% lush	9% water	7% grateful
European	18% Liam	18% Lily	14% kingdom	12% nestled	10% spent	9% dragon
Middle Eastern	33% ali	21% called	19% known	14% cave	14% valley	13% magnificent
North American	17% Lily	11% bed	9% end	7% kingdom	7% smiled	6% drifted
South American	27% Diego	26% vibrant	13% lush	9% soft	7% secret	7% surrounded
Nationality Parent Developed						
Developed	27% Lily	16% bed	16% kingdom	14% Liam	14% end	13% nestled
Developing	21% near	21% river	20% lush	16% called	14% adventurous	13% Ali
Ethnicity						
African-Amer.	63% kofi	60% ada	47% vibrant	30% lush	24% remember	15% wise
Asian	63% Mei	26% grew	24% lush	19% nestled	18% grow	15% took
European-Amer.	36% mia	28% kingdom	25% away	24% Sofia	24% called	22% dragon
Latino	58% Diego	39% Maria	34% Isabela	33% nestled	28% hill	20% approached
Middle-Eastern	73% sand	44% karim	42% Aisha	39% Hassan	36% Noor	23% granted
White	52% Lily	38% away	30% kingdom	23% Liam	22% prince	20% came
Religion						
Atheist	21% Lily	14% Liam	11% valley	7% secret	7% came	6% spent
Buddhist	16% nestled	14% let	13% wise	10% listened	8% gently	6% parent
Christian	19% parent	7% sweet	7% hidden	6% shimmering	6% soft	5% vibrant
Hindu	7% tell	7% magnificent	7% adventurous	7% brave	7% smiled	6% lush
Jew	22% hill	14% bed	12% nestled	12% drifted	11% tell	8% king
Muslim	35% mother	10% Aisha	6% warm	6% went	5% set	5% shimmering
Role						
father	7% tell	7% magnificent	7% adventurous	7% brave	7% smiled	6% lush
mother	35% mother	10% Aisha	6% warm	6% went	5% set	5% shimmering
parent	19% parent	7% sweet	7% hidden	6% shimmering	6% soft	5% vibrant

Table 10: Top words in the **text of the generated story by Mixtral model** that correlate (Pearson) with the sociocultural factor. The terms *child*, *daughter*, and *son* have been removed, as they are almost present at the start of the generation

Gender Of Child											
child	7%	little	6%	fur	6%	soft	6%	shimmering	5%	white coat	5% hopeful
daughter	11%	hair	8%	black	8%	gentle	7%	imaginative	5%	bright	5% loving
son	14%	young	6%	adventurous	6%	hero	5%	brave	5%	eager	5% wise
Nationality Parent Group											
Africa	10%	wise	6%	clever	5%	spirit	4%	decisive	4%	young	4% respectful
Asia	10%	pure	7%	gentle	7%	chosen	6%	kind	5%	loving	5% hearted
European	7%	friendly	5%	suprised	5%	golden	4%	drawn	4%	warm	4% imaginative
Middle Eastern	8%	young	6%	hero	5%	wide	5%	proud	4%	courageous	3% challenged
North American	5%	suprised	4%	thrilled	4%	tiny	4%	excited	4%	dreamer	3% imaginative
South American	8%	joyous	7%	wings	7%	sparkling	6%	tiny	5%	eyes	5% guardian
Nationality Parent Developed											
Developed	7%	suprised	6%	friendly	6%	little	6%	fur	4%	helpful	4% golden
Developing	9%	young	8%	wise	4%	sparkling	4%	loved	4%	black	4% leader
Ethnicity Of Parent											
African-Amer.	38%	heritage	34%	proud	28%	connected	26%	strong	23%	inspired	23% purposeful
Asian	15%	wise	15%	noble	13%	kind	11%	peaceful	11%	perseverant	11% hearted
European-Amer.	19%	golden	17%	blue	15%	friendly	13%	open	13%	brave	13% observant
Latino	27%	oriented	25%	family	16%	sparkling	16%	loving	13%	connected	12% eyes
Middle-Eastern	20%	wise	14%	generous	13%	selfless	13%	compassionate	12%	weaver	10% clever
White	21%	friendly	16%	helpful	15%	empathetic	11%	blue	10%	brown	10% grateful
Religion Of Parent											
Atheist	46%	minded	45%	inquisitive	36%	open	31%	nature	28%	observant	25% connected
Buddhist	40%	mindful	33%	understanding	31%	peaceful	31%	compassionate	21%	empathetic	18% patient
Christian	39%	faithful	32%	trusting	32%	loving	27%	caring	15%	hopeful	14% peaceful
Hindu	22%	pure	17%	respectful	16%	magical	16%	selfless	15%	wise	12% brave
Jew	48%	heritage	42%	tradition	30%	family	27%	oriented	23%	excitable	22% proud
Muslim	26%	faithful	21%	grateful	19%	devoted	18%	patient	17%	kind	16% spiritual
Role Of Parent											
father	5%	decisive	5%	wise	5%	explorer	4%	protector	4%	amazed	4% celebrated
mother	6%	dear	5%	shimmering	5%	free	4%	loved	4%	soft	4% tiny
parent	5%	careful	4%	spirited	4%	magical	4%	connected	3%	understanding	3% grateful

Table 11: Top words in **children attributes** in the generated story that correlate (Pearson) with the target variable (e.g., child gender or parent's nationality). Obvious variables that correspond to the input (such as *boy*) are removed. **Color codes:** blue = physical; red = emotional; green = mental; yellow = moral; gray = other.

Gender						
child	13% fur	10% little	9% grateful	9% playful	6% wise	5% nature
daughter	19% smile	18% hair	18% eyes	16% heart	15% light	15% golden
son	19% adventurous	16% curious	14% brave	11% eager	10% courageous	9% determined
Nationality Parent Group						
Africa	8% brave	6% adventurous	5% curiosity	5% big	5% imaginative	4% eager
Asia	9% playful	8% content	8% adventurous	8% warmth	7% joyful	7% grateful
European	15% blue	15% hair	14% golden	13% faith	11% bright	8% peaceful
Middle Eastern	7% young	7% imaginative	6% brave	6% big	6% determined	5% courageous
North American	10% compassionate	9% fur	9% nature	7% learn	6% warm	6% helpful
South American	9% adventurous	8% brown	7% playful	6% mischievous	6% curious	5% little
Nationality Parent Developed						
Developed	14% blue	13% faith	12% compassionate	12% hair	11% golden	11% gentle
Developing	14% adventurous	13% imaginative	9% determined	6% excitement	6% brave	6% big
Ethnicity						
African-Amer.	54% strong	36% resilient	33% courageous	31% confident	30% beautiful	24% dark
Asian	18% peaceful	13% wonder	11% gentle	10% sense	9% unwavering	9% happy
European-Amer.	21% long	19% flowing	18% blue	16% gift	14% golden	13% joy
Latino	21% magic	19% excited	18% brown	16% curly	16% like	16% bright
Middle-Eastern	16% intently	15% spirit	14% kindness	10% heart	10% pure	10% adventure
White	26% sparkling	21% helpful	18% golden	18% blue	14% gentle	13% white
Religion						
Atheist	21% open	17% understanding	16% awe	13% sense	12% learn	10% curious
Buddhist	30% understanding	25% compassionate	18% gentle	17% nature	11% loves	10% peaceful
Christian	10% joyful	9% faith	9% eye	9% kindness	8% determined	8% heart
Hindu	11% brave	10% wise	8% courageous	4% strong	4% selfless	4% pure
Jew	15% learn	7% compassion	6% kind	6% kindness	6% eager	6% loving
Muslim	7% imaginative	7% sleepy	6% adventurous	4% peaceful	4% loved	4% comforted
Role						
father	11% brave	10% wise	8% courageous	4% strong	4% selfless	4% pure
mother	7% imaginative	7% sleepy	6% adventurous	4% peaceful	4% loved	4% comforted
parent	10% joyful	9% faith	9% eye	9% kindness	8% determined	8% heart

Table 12: Top words in the **Character-Centric Attributes by GPT-4o** that correlate (Pearson) with the sociocultural factor. The terms *child*, *daughter*, and *son* have been removed, as they are almost present at the start of the generation

Gender						
child	11% little	7% explore	6% grateful	6% loved	5% helpful	5% friend
daughter	26% gentle	26% hair	19% kind	17% black	16% beautiful	16% bright
son	24% brave	15% young	13% adventurous	11% courageous	10% curious	10% determined
Nationality Parent Group						
Africa	12% land	11% bright	9% secret	8% respectful	7% young	7% black
Asia	12% kind	9% spreads	8% black	7% kindness	6% hearted	6% soft
European	17% blue	8% hair	7% beautiful	7% peace	6% brown	6% compassionate
Middle Eastern	12% eyed	8% young	6% courageous	5% imaginative	5% brave	5% fascinated
North American	10% loving	9% grateful	8% understanding	8% explore	7% friend	7% peaceful
South American	10% little	7% black	7% thrilled	4% friend	4% guided	4% playful
Nationality Parent Developed						
Developed	13% blue	12% peaceful	11% grateful	9% loving	8% understanding	8% peace
Developing	17% black	8% eyed	8% hearted	8% story	8% young	7% brave
Ethnicity						
African-Amer.	46% strong	34% rich	33% skin	30% resilient	24% purpose	22% proud
Asian	28% compassionate	26% kind	24% respectful	17% gentle	12% eager	9% wise
European-Amer.	25% blue	18% eye	17% brown	15% magical	15% determined	14% excited
Latino	26% big	25% heritage	24% felt	23% black	23% mop	22% magic
Middle-Eastern	26% eyed	23% eyes	17% wise	17% black	16% sky	15% bright
White	19% loving	18% kind	18% grateful	14% gift	13% explore	13% loved
Religion						
Atheist	13% connection	11% sense	10% awe	10% feels	9% star	9% shining
Buddhist	31% peaceful	24% understanding	23% compassionate	15% loving	14% grateful	8% beautiful
Christian	5% clever	5% curious	5% smile	4% adventure	4% courage	4% amazed
Hindu	15% brave	8% determined	7% adventurous	5% strong	5% bright	4% young
Jew	8% warm	7% connected	6% felt	6% loving	6% wide	6% wise
Muslim	10% soft	6% big	5% loved	5% special	5% little	4% joyful
Role						
father	15% brave	8% determined	7% adventurous	5% strong	5% bright	4% young
mother	10% soft	6% big	5% loved	5% special	5% little	4% joyful
parent	5% clever	5% curious	5% smile	4% adventure	4% courage	4% amazed

Table 13: Top words in the **Character-Centric Attributes by Llama3** that correlate (Pearson) with the sociocultural factor. The terms *child*, *daughter*, and *son* have been removed, as they are almost present at the start of the generation

Gender						
child	6% gentle	5% friend	5% knowledgeable	5% wise	5% hardworking	5% happy
daughter	21% beautiful	12% hair	10% eye	9% hearted	9% loving	9% smile
son	9% curious	9% young	8% respected	8% respectful	6% brave	5% thoughtful
Nationality Parent Group						
Africa	7% heart	7% kindness	6% determined	5% strong	5% wisdom	5% adventurous
Asia	10% hardworking	9% respectful	9% kind	8% hearted	8% grateful	8% fascinated
European	11% gentle	11% hair	10% eye	10% golden	9% long	9% faithful
Middle Eastern	9% adventurous	8% just	7% love	6% courageous	6% brave	5% dedicated
North American	8% explore	8% young	7% sweet	6% patient	6% gift	5% loving
South American	10% curious	8% inspiring	7% boundless	6% deep	6% enchanted	5% gift
Nationality Parent Developed						
Developed	12% hair	11% golden	10% faithful	10% blue	10% eye	10% gentle
Developing	14% curious	12% adventurous	9% hearted	8% fascinated	8% brave	7% animal
Ethnicity						
African-Amer.	42% african	30% skin	24% radiant	24% spirit	24% american	23% big
Asian	35% gentle	17% overjoyed	16% skilled	16% patient	14% helpful	12% proud
European-Amer.	42% european	34% half	24% special	24% american	23% unique	21% gift
Latino	19% fascinated	19% curious	17% excited	16% skilled	16% curly	16% insatiable
Middle-Eastern	28% generous	23% boundless	21% selfless	18% humble	16% wonder	13% knowledge
White	48% white	34% blue	30% golden	28% hair	21% beautiful	21% sparkling
Religion						
Atheist	9% imaginative	8% young	7% leader	7% bright	6% learning	5% inspiring
Buddhist	46% mindful	25% peaceful	22% compassionate	21% wise	16% understanding	11% patient
Christian	7% love	6% nature	6% captivated	6% faithful	5% loves	5% deep
Hindu	9% just	7% adventurous	7% brave	6% skilled	6% protective	5% strong
Jew	10% gentle	10% humble	10% wise	9% learning	8% known	7% proud
Muslim	10% little	9% curious	7% kind	7% heart	6% joy	6% eye
Role						
father	9% just	7% adventurous	7% brave	6% skilled	6% protective	5% strong
mother	10% little	9% curious	7% kind	7% heart	6% joy	6% eye
parent	7% love	6% nature	6% captivated	6% faithful	5% loves	5% deep

Table 14: Top words in the **Character-Centric Attributes by Mixtral** that correlate (Pearson) with the sociocultural factor. The terms *child*, *daughter*, and *son* have been removed, as they are almost present at the start of the generation.

Nationality	Italian=47% Amer.=49% British=52% Indian=53% Afghan=54% Russian=55% Filipino=56% Iranian=56% Japanese=56% Mexican=57% South African=57% Sudanese=57% Tajik=57% Iraqi=57% Malian=57% Chinese=58% Indonesian=58% Nigerian=58% German=58% Egyptian=58% Vietnamese=58% Ethiopian=58% Thai=58% Azerbaijani=59% Armenian=59% Kenyan=60% Brazilian=60% Sri Lankan=61%
Nationality Developed	Developed=48% Developing=49%
Nationality Group	European=48% North Amer.=49% Asia=51% Middle Eastern=52% Africa=54% South Amer.=56%
Gender	son=48% child=48% daughter=52%
Ethnicity	Asian=54% African-Amer.=55% European-Amer.=56% Latino=56% Middle-Eastern=56% White=57%
Religion	Hindu=47% Christian=48% Muslim=49% Jew=52% Atheist=56% Buddhist=57%
Role	father=47% parent=48% mother=49%

Table 15: Average inner product similarity (all-MiniLM-L6-v2, Reimers and Gurevych, 2019b) between stories generated with specific prompts. A lower number means higher diversity, which is better.

Nationality	Italian=55% Amer.=56% British=61% Nigerian=62% Indian=62% Mexican=63% Malian=63% Chinese=64% Ethiopian=65% Iranian=65% Sudanese=65% Indonesian=65% Japanese=65% Afghan=66% South African=66% Egyptian=66% Russian=66% Tajik=67% Armenian=67% Vietnamese=68% Iraqi=68% Thai=68% German=69% Azerbaijani=70% Filipino=70% Sri Lankan=70% Brazilian=71% Kenyan=71%
Nationality Developed	Developed=56% Developing=56%
Nationality Group	North Amer.=56% European=56% Asia=58% Africa=60% Middle Eastern=61% South Amer.=63%
Gender	child=55% son=55% daughter=60%
Ethnicity	African-Amer.=62% Asian=63% White=66% Latino=68% Middle-Eastern=69% European-Amer.=70%
Religion	Hindu=54% Christian=55% Muslim=57% Buddhist=63% Jew=64% Atheist=64%
Role	father=54% parent=55% mother=57%

Table 16: Average inner product similarity (all-MiniLM-L6-v2, Reimers and Gurevych, 2019b) between stories generated with specific prompts. A lower number means higher diversity, which is better. Model: GPT-4o

Nationality	Italian=50% Amer.=56% British=58% Russian=59% Tajik=59% Filipino=59% German=60% Indonesian=60% Afghan=61% Indian=62% Vietnamese=62% Thai=62% Mexican=63% Brazilian=63% Nigerian=64% Iraqi=64% Egyptian=64% Armenian=65% Sudanese=65% Chinese=65% Malian=66% Azerbaijani=66% South African=66% Japanese=67% Ethiopian=67% Sri Lankan=67% Kenyan=67% Iranian=67%
Nationality Developed	Developed=52% Developing=53%
Nationality Group	European=50% Asia=54% North Amer.=56% Middle Eastern=57% South Amer.=59% Africa=60%
Gender	son=50% child=52% daughter=56%
Ethnicity	Middle-Eastern=61% European-Amer.=62% Latino=63% African-Amer.=65% Asian=66% White=66%
Religion	Hindu=50% Muslim=52% Christian=52% Jew=61% Atheist=70% Buddhist=70%
Role	father=50% mother=52% parent=52%

Table 17: Average inner product similarity (all-MiniLM-L6-v2, Reimers and Gurevych, 2019b) between stories generated with specific prompts. A lower number means higher diversity, which is better. Model: Llama3

Nationality	Amer.=45% Italian=46% British=50% Indian=52% Iranian=53% Japanese=55% South African=55% Egyptian=56% Filipino=56% Afghan=56% Sudanese=57% Russian=57% Thai=57% Iraqi=57% Vietnamese=57% Malian=58% Ethiopian=59% Armenian=59% German=59% Azerbaijani=60% Mexican=60% Brazilian=60% Chinese=60% Nigerian=61% Tajik=61% Sri Lankan=62% Kenyan=62% Indonesian=62%
Nationality Developed	Developed=46% Developing=48%
Nationality Group	North Amer.=45% European=47% Asia=50% Middle Eastern=51% Africa=52% South Amer.=56%
Gender	child=46% son=47% daughter=50%
Ethnicity	Asian=53% Middle-Eastern=54% European-Amer.=55% White=57% African-Amer.=57% Latino=58%
Religion	Hindu=46% Christian=47% Muslim=49% Jew=50% Buddhist=56% Atheist=56%
Role	father=46% parent=47% mother=49%

Table 18: Average inner product similarity (all-MiniLM-L6-v2, Reimers and Gurevych, 2019b) between stories generated with specific prompts. A lower number means higher diversity, which is better. Model: Mixtral8x